

Grammar and Vocabulary: The past passive

Lesson 4-2
Book pages 40

💡 **Big idea:** We use the **past passive** (**was/were + past participle**) when the **object** is more important than the subject, or when we do not know or care who did the action. We add **by** to say who did it.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Recognise active and passive sentences
- Form the past passive correctly
- Use by to show who did the action
- Find examples of the past passive in a text

📖 Key words

active مبني للمعلوم	**passive** مبني للمجهول	**past participle** التصريف الثالث للفعل	**subject** الفاعل
object المفعول به	**frankincense** اللبان	**tomb** قبر / مدفن	**pharaoh** فرعون

Active vs passive

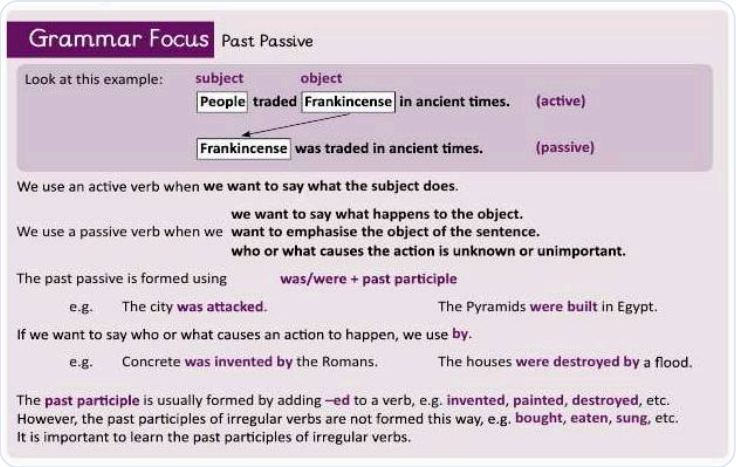
- **Active**: People **traded** frankincense in ancient times (we say what the subject does)
- **Passive**: Frankincense **was traded** in ancient times (we focus on the object)
- We use the passive when the doer is **unknown or unimportant**

Forming the past passive

- **was / were + past participle**
- The city **was attacked**
- The Pyramids **were built** in Egypt
- Use **by** for the doer: Concrete was invented **by** the Romans
- The houses were destroyed **by** a flood

Past participles

- Regular: add **-ed**: invented, painted, destroyed
- Irregular: bought, eaten, sung, built, found, written
- Examples: Cuneiform was invented by the Sumerians
- The Lost City of Ubar was found by archaeologists
- The Roman city of Pompeii was destroyed



Grammar Focus: the past passive

✏️ Examples

Make passive: The Sumerians invented cuneiform.

Answer: Cuneiform was invented by the Sumerians.

Complete: The pyramids ___ (use) as tombs for the pharaohs.

Answer: were used

Why passive in "The city was attacked"?

Answer: The attacker is not known or not important

⭐ Remember

- Singular object → was, plural object → were
- Learn irregular past participles: build → built, find → found, write → written

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ The Pyramids was built. ✓ The Pyramids were built.
- ✗ It was invent by ✓ It was invented by

🧩 **Activity:** Write six passive sentences about Omani history (forts, ships, frankincense)

✅ Check yourself

1. Form of the past passive?
2. Past participle of build?
3. Which word shows the doer?

Answers: (1) was/were + past participle ، (2) built ، (3) by